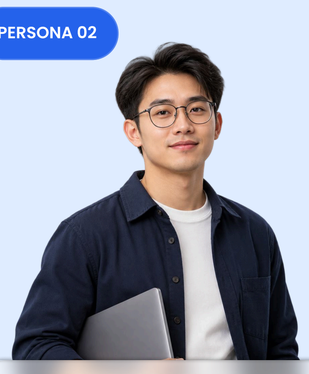
User **persona**

Meet the plain-text perfectionist: **fast, structured, keyboard-first**

PERSONA 02



POWER USER

Phạm Đức Anh

Information

Age	27
Gender	Male
Job	Backend developer at a software outsourcing company; part-time Master's in Data Science
Location	Danang, Vietnam
Marital status	Married (1 year), no children
Income	~30,000,000 VND/month (~1,200 USD)
Tech skill	●●●●● **Expert** – writes Markdown & LaTeX daily, uses Git, lives on keyboard shortcuts, customises every tool
Preferred devices	**MacBook Pro** (primary – work & thesis) · **iPhone** (capture during commute & meetings) · company Windows PC

Personality

Analytical · Perfectionist · Introverted · Efficient

> *If I can't write it in Markdown and find it again in two seconds, it doesn't exist.*

Tools he uses today

Obsidian · VS Code · Notion (company wiki) · Apple Notes · Overleaf · GitHub

01 Bio

Đức Anh writes backend services by day and a Master's thesis on recommender systems by night.

His knowledge lives in Markdown: meeting notes, API docs, code snippets, paper summaries full of formulas.

He uses Obsidian on the Mac but finds its mobile app clunky and paid sync expensive, so ideas captured on the iPhone end up in Apple Notes and never get merged.

02 Goals

- ✓ Keep work, thesis and personal notes in **one plain-text knowledge base he owns**.
- ✓ Write formulas, tables and code without fighting the editor.
- ✓ Link ideas between papers, meetings and code (backlinks, embeds).
- ✓ Do everything from the keyboard; find any note in two seconds.
- ✓ Export clean `.md` / PDF to send to his thesis advisor.

03 Motivation

Build a "second brain" that will still open in ten years – and finish his thesis while working full time.

04 Needs

- ✓ Markdown-first editor with **Source mode**, Live Preview and Reading mode.
- ✓ **LaTeX autocomplete**, numbered equations, matrices.
- ✓ `[[backlinks]]`, link to headings/blocks, **embed notes**, aliases.
- ✓ Code blocks with syntax highlighting; tables that auto-align.
- ✓ **Query blocks** to list open tasks across notes.
- ✓ Plain `.md` export/import (Obsidian vault compatible); offline-first, fast free sync.
- ✓ Ctrl+K command palette, full keyboard shortcuts, dark mode.

05 Pain Points

- ! Obsidian sync is paid and its mobile app feels slow; notes split between Mac and iPhone.
- ! Notion is slow, uses proprietary blocks, and export breaks formulas.
- ! Equations in Word / Google Docs are painful; he rewrites them in Overleaf.
- ! Markdown tables are tedious to align by hand.
- ! Meeting tasks get lost inside long notes – no single "what's due" view.

07 Behavior

01 Opens the note app with a shortcut 30+ times a day; never touches the mouse while writing.

02 Writes meeting notes in Markdown with `- [ ]` tasks and `@date` deadlines.

03 Summarises 3–4 research papers a week with formulas and links between them.

04 Pastes code snippets and terminal output; tags by project `#work/api`, `#thesis/ch2`.

05 Captures quick ideas on the iPhone during the commute, refines them on the Mac.

06 Reviews a "dashboard" note every Monday listing open tasks.

07 Backs up everything in Git; distrusts tools that lock his data in.

06 Summary

Đức Anh needs a fast, Markdown-native note system that he fully owns – with first-class formulas, links and code – that syncs his Mac and iPhone for free and never locks his knowledge into a proprietary format.

Brand value

Obsidian	Local Markdown files – he owns his data
GitHub	Version history, open formats, developer-first
Apple	Polish, speed, devices that work together
Linear / Raycast	Keyboard-first, instant, minimal

speed, open formats, privacy, keyboard control, no lock-in.

08 Opportunities

01 / **Source mode with line numbers**, Ctrl+E to switch Live Preview / Source / Reading (2.2).

02 / **LaTeX autocomplete** with Tab placeholders, `\tag{}`, `align`, matrices; KaTeX offline (23.4).

03 / **Backlinks, heading/block links,** `![[embed]]`, **aliases** to connect papers ↔ meetings ↔ code (11, 23.5).

04 / **Tables that auto-align**, paste from Excel/CSV, copy as LaTeX for the thesis (23.3).

05 / `- [ ] Fix API ⏰ 2026-01-12 09:00` + **query block** dashboard of open tasks (16, 23.6, 23.7).

06 / **Code blocks** with highlighting, Mermaid diagrams for architecture (23.2, 23.8).

07 / **Ctrl+K palette, full shortcuts, slash menu** (13, 23.9).

08 / **Plain** `.md` **export/import**, Obsidian-vault compatible; line-level merge on sync conflict (19, 23.10).

09 / **Fast free sync Mac ↔ iPhone**, quick capture widget on iPhone (1, 19).